ACTIVITY 102

First Ten Seconds

Performance Preparation

6 minutes / Opening note and first phrase.

Make the beginning of a performance predictable.

READY → **EYE CONTACT** → **PREPARATION** → **FIRST SOUND**

READY	EYE CONTACT	PREPARATION	FIRST SOUND
Find support	See the hand	Ordinary breath	Enter together

Practise this beginning after different lengths of silence.

1. Practise the silent sequence: ready position, eye contact, preparation, and entrance.
2. Add the opening phrase once, then stop and reset rather than continuing the whole song.
3. Repeat with a longer audience-like pause so singers learn to wait for the cue.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The group starts together even after an unfamiliar pause.

COMMON TRAP

Starting the phrase before everyone sees the cue.

MAKE IT WORK

Supply the starting note immediately before every attempt.